AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS XII EXAMINATION

APRIL/ MAY 2019

English Compulsory Paper II

Time: 2 hours 05 minutes Marks: 60

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INSTRUCTIONS

Please read the following instructions carefully.

1. Check your name and school information. Sign if it is accurate.

I agree that this is my name and school. **Candidate's Signature**

RUBRIC

2. There are FOUR questions. Answer ALL questions. Question 3 offers TWO choices and Question 4 offers THREE choices. Attempt any ONE of the options in each.

3. When answering the questions:

   Read each question carefully.
   Use a black pointer to write your answers. DO NOT write your answers in pencil.
   Use a black pencil for diagrams. DO NOT use coloured pencils.
   DO NOT use staples, paper clips, glue, correcting fluid or ink erasers.
   Complete your answer in the allocated space only. DO NOT write outside the answer box.

4. The marks for the questions are shown in brackets ( ).

Q.1. (Total 17 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and then answer all the questions that follow:

Not long ago, the ultimate put-down among children was calling someone 'ugly'. Today, the most common reason kids are bullied is weight. And the consequences are no joke. Compared to their peers, children with obesity have lower self-esteem and are also more likely to refuse to participate in extra-curricular activities. Fat shaming is damaging the self-esteem and confidence of millions of people. Millions of adults are fat-shamed, some very publicly.

All that is really known about obesity by the general public is that less exercise and more food makes a person fat. Fat people are aware of this equation. The failure to lose weight is taken as evidence of ignorance of this golden formula, which thin people constantly remind obese people of, often to feel better about their own bodies and an imagined expertise in fitness.

If the fat person claims that he already knows the rule, the next assumption made is that he's too lazy or undisciplined to act on this information.

Individuals born with metabolic silver-spoons in their mouths snicker at people struggling with their weight problem, much like rich kids who roll their eyes at poor people struggling to pay their bills.

The point above is lost on many who see seven billion humans as their own biological clones; assuming that any technique or remedy working for them, must also work for everyone else. This is especially true for those who have succeeded in losing significant weight.

The absurdity of that assumption is easily noted by physicians like myself, who wonder why the same drug, with dose carefully adjusted according to each patient's weight and age, has varying degrees of effects on different patients; even outright failing to show any response in, say, 10 per cent of them.

The answer can be complicated. While the golden formula of weight gain as food intake minus exercise is theoretically true, it does not take into account many genetic, pathological, socioeconomic and pharmacological factors that either facilitate or impede weight gain. Idiosyncrasies matter tremendously.

To begin with, there actually is such a thing as an 'obesity gene'. A fault in the gene – responsible for storing energy as fat rather than burning for heat – may explain many cases of early-onset and sustained obesity. Even the absence of certain gut microbes can affect satiety; hence, cause weight gain. Contrary to the public's perception of obesity as a symbol of greed and decadence – used frequently in political caricatures to depict corrupt politicians and bureaucratic 'fat cats' – obesity may paradoxically be a consequence of poverty and malnutrition.

Fat shaming isn't just unkind, it's physically, economically and psychologically damaging. Yet it remains socially acceptable.

Source: Adapted from '*Fat-Shaming is Not Community Service*' by Faraz Talat

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a. Based on your experience, briefly narrate an account when you saw someone being fat-shamed and the impact it had on you. (4 Marks)

b. Mention any TWO phrases from paragraph 2 which indicate sarcasm. (2 Marks)

c. Describe, in your own words, why would the author use the expression 'fat cats' in paragraph 8 for 'corrupt politicians and bureaucrats'. Write in THREE points. (3 Marks)

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d. Sometimes people may unintentionally fat-shame those individuals who are struggling with obesity. With reference to the given passage, describe THREE causes behind such behaviour. (3 Marks)

e. Summarise the given passage in no more than 100 words. (5 Marks)

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Q.2. (Total 10 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and fill in each of the blanks with **ONE** suitable word.

The first significant 1) _____ towards legally protecting the high seas are to take place 2) _____ the United Nations (UN) in New York. These waters, defined as the open ocean, far from coastlines, are threatened by deep-sea mining, over-fishing and the patenting of marine genetic resources.

Over the next two years, government representatives aim to hammer out a binding agreement to protect them against over-exploitation. But 3) _____ nations, including the United States, are lukewarm towards the proposal.

Experts 4) _____ that the oceans of the world are vital for a number of reasons. Scientists say that they capture around 90% of the extra heat and about 26% of the excess carbon dioxide created by humans through the burning of fossil fuels 5) _____ other activities.

"The half of our planet which is high seas is protecting terrestrial life from the worst impacts of climate change," said Prof Alex Rogers from Oxford University, United Kingdom, who 6) _____ provided evidence to inform the UN treaty process getting under way on Tuesday.

The high seas are defined as the oceans 7) _____ lie beyond exclusive economic zones. These zones are usually within 370 km of a country's coastline. These waters cover one and a half times the total land area of the planet and are home 8) _____ some of the rarest and most charismatic species – but all countries have the right to navigate, fly over, carryout scientific research and fish on the high seas without restriction.

Some whale-hunting countries, such as Japan, Iceland and Norway, are said to be cautious about the idea because they fear it will restrict 9) _____ fishing operations. Russia is also said to be dragging its feet.

Campaigners, though, are optimistic that eventually 10) _____ deal will be reached.

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Q.3. (Total 15 Marks)

Compose a formal piece of writing of around 250-300 words on any **ONE** of the options **a** or **b**.

EITHER

a. Pakistan is a developing country with a larger number of working class individuals. The country is being troubled with many issues such as economic inflation (rising prices of goods) and shortage of resources.

Write an email to the Editor of a renowned newspaper. In your email,

- highlight the impact of economic inflation and shortage of resources on the society.
- suggest TWO solutions for the mentioned issues to the government through the newspaper.

OR

b. An advertisement firm is looking for a young freelance (work from home) researcher for their firm. You have suitable academic qualifications and skills for this position; therefore, you are interested to apply for the job.

Write a covering letter and develop a suitable CV to apply for the given position. Include the following details in your covering letter:

- Why are you a suitable candidate?
- How would this job help you in developing your career?

(**Note**: The content of the covering letter and CV should be realistic, considering that you are a student of Grade XII.)

Make your notes on the pages given for rough work. Write your final draft on pages 7, 8 and 9.

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Q.4. (Total 18 Marks)

Write a composition of about 350-400 words on any **ONE** of the options **a, b** or **c.**
Remember to compose the final draft in complete sentences.

EITHER

a. Carbonated drinks, commonly known as soft drinks, are heavily marketed on various media, including posters and television commercials. However, research has shown that regular consumption of carbonated drinks leads to many health issues, including calcium deficiency.

Write a persuasive essay expressing your views about marketing of carbonated drinks. In your essay, mention

- your opinion regarding such marketing practices.
- at least THREE reasons to support your stance.
- at least ONE effect of marketing of carbonated drinks on a person's health.

OR

b. "I woke up to the sounds of sirens on the street. I panicked and got out of bed to investigate the reason for such chaos…"

Narrate a story starting with the given sentences.

OR

c. According to James Clear, "The basic idea is that the beliefs you have about yourself can drive your long-term behaviour. Maybe you can trick yourself into going to the gym or eating healthy once or twice, but if you don't shift your underlying identity, then it's hard to stick with long-term changes."

Hence, many people are hesitant to change their habits.

Narrate about a time when you tried to change a bad habit. In you narration, include:

- what prompted you to change your habit.
- what steps did you take.
- what was the outcome.

Make your notes on the pages given for rough work. Write your final draft on pages 11, 12 and 13.

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